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The data presented in the passage are LEAST likely to have been obtained from which type of study?

- ☐ A. Cross-sectional [6%]
- ☐ B. Longitudinal [6%]

☐ C. Case [6%]

✓ ☒ D. Randomized controlled trial [79%]

Correct

80% answered correctly

### Explanation:

| Types of studies in the health sciences |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Experimental                            |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Randomized controlled trial             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Random allocation into treatment &amp; placebo groups</li><li>• Can determine efficacy of the intervention</li></ul>                           |
| Nonrandomized design                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Nonrandom allocation into treatment &amp; placebo groups</li><li>• Can determine efficacy of the intervention</li></ul>                        |
| Observational                           |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Longitudinal                            | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Data gathered at multiple time points</li><li>• Can assess risk factors or outcomes</li></ul>                                                  |
| Cross-sectional                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Data gathered at one point in time</li><li>• Can determine prevalence of an outcome in a population</li></ul>                                  |
| Case-control                            | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Data gathered from individuals with the condition of interest (cases) &amp; compared to individuals without the condition (controls)</li></ul> |
| Case                                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Detailed information gathered about one individual (or a small group of individuals)</li></ul>                                                 |
| Review                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Meta-analysis                           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Data from multiple studies are statistically combined &amp; analyzed</li></ul>                                                                 |

**Randomized controlled trials** involve the **random assignment** of subjects into treatment and control groups (eg, patients are randomly assigned to receive a new drug or a placebo), and **causal conclusions** can be drawn from the results. No data in the passage involve efficacy of a treatment/intervention or a causal relationship, so the data were *least* likely to have been obtained from randomized controlled trials.

**(Choice A)** Cross-sectional studies are observational studies that assess data from a large section of the population at a given point and can determine the prevalence of a disease. The statistic that "as many as half of all individuals diagnosed with BD actually do not have the disorder" was most likely from a cross-sectional study.

**(Choice B)** Longitudinal studies are observational studies that gather data over time. The statistic that "almost 70% of patients [receive] an initial misdiagnosis and almost 35% [remain] misdiagnosed for 10 years or more" most likely came from a longitudinal study.

**(Choice C)** Case studies are observational studies that assess one or more individuals in depth over a certain period. The quotes from the patients in the passage were likely taken from a case study.

**Educational objective:**

The health sciences use three main study designs: Reviews, experimental studies (causality can be inferred), and observational studies (causality cannot be inferred). Randomized controlled trials determine treatment efficacy by comparing randomly assigned groups. Cross-sectional studies can determine disease prevalence. Cohort studies observe changes in a group over time. Case studies provide an in-depth analysis of one or a few individuals.

**Time spent:**0 sec

**Subject:**  
Behavioral Sciences

**QID:**400605

**System:**  
Demographics and Social Structure

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I am."

Based on the information in the passage and sick role theory, which statement best describes a potential explanation for the underdiagnosis of BD? Underdiagnosis of BD is the result of:

- ☐ A. society's failure to exempt individuals with BD from normal social roles. [29%]
- ☐ B. people holding loved ones with BD accountable for their illness. [3%]
- ☐ C. doctors failing to discuss the rights of illness with those with BD. [5%]
- ✔ ☒ D. individuals with BD failing to meet the obligations of illness. [60%]

Correct

61% answered correctly

### Explanation:

| Sick role theory (Talcott Parsons) |                                                                                                   |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Rights</b>                      | 1. Exemption from normal social roles & responsibilities<br>2. Lack of accountability for illness |
| <b>Obligations</b>                 | 1. Must attempt to get well<br>2. Must seek & comply with treatment                               |

In sociology, **sick role theory** conceptualizes illness as a **socially acceptable** form of **deviance**. When ill, an individual enters into the "sick role," a socially defined status with rights and obligations:

- **Rights:** The sick person has the right to be exempt from playing other social roles while sick (eg, employee) and is excused from fulfilling normal responsibilities (eg, going to work). The sick person also has the right to not be held responsible for the illness.
- **Obligations:** The sick person has the responsibility to make every reasonable effort to get well as soon as possible. The sick person also has the responsibility to seek medical help and to cooperate with medical professionals (eg, follow their treatment plan).

The passage states that the underdiagnosis of BD might be partially attributed to individuals with BD who may not realize that their manic episodes are problematic and/or seek treatment for them (Paragraph 3). Therefore, a potential explanation for the underdiagnosis of BD, based on the information in the passage and sick role theory, is that individuals with BD fail to meet the obligations of illness (ie, seeking

medical help).

**(Choice A)** According to sick role theory, failure of society to exempt individuals with BD from their normal social roles violates a right of illness but does not explain why BD is so often underdiagnosed.

**(Choice B)** According to sick role theory, people holding loved ones with BD accountable for their illness would violate a right of illness, but this does not explain why BD is so often underdiagnosed.

**(Choice C)** The passage suggests that physicians may be too willing to grant the rights of illness to BD patients to the extent that they *overdiagnose* the illness, as exemplified by the physician's quote.

**Educational objective:**

According to sick role theory, a sick person has the right to be excused from normal responsibilities and to be held blameless for the illness. A sick person has the obligation to attempt to get well as soon as possible, and to seek and comply with the advice of medical professionals.

**Time spent:**0 sec  
**Subject:**  
Behavioral Sciences

**QID:**400606  
**System:**  
Demographics and Social Structure

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Which of the following symptoms, if present, would help a clinician diagnose bipolar disorder rather than borderline personality disorder?

- ✓ ☒ A. Lack of interest in activities previously enjoyed [44%]  
☐ B. Impulsive or reckless behavior [32%]  
☐ C. Fear of abandonment [7%]  
☐ D. Suicidal ideation [15%]

Correct

44% answered correctly

### Explanation:

**Bipolar disorders** (BD) are characterized by **mania**, defined as an abnormally **elevated** or irritable **mood** and increased **energy**. Manic episodes may also include feelings of grandiosity, reduced need for sleep, **flight of ideas** (rapid thoughts), and impulsive or reckless behaviors (eg, extreme spending, promiscuous sexual activity).

Most people with BD also experience depressive episodes. **Depressive episodes** share the same symptoms as depressive disorder, such as feelings of sadness or hopelessness, lack of interest in activities, sleep disturbances, and frequent thoughts of death or suicide.

Borderline personality disorder is characterized by instability in mood, sense of self, and relationships. Symptoms may include extreme mood reactivity, fear of abandonment, impulsive or reckless behavior (eg, drug use, unsafe sex), and suicidal or self-harming behavior.

Lack of interest in activities previously enjoyed is a symptom that *may be* present in BD and depressive disorder, but is not characteristic of borderline personality disorder; therefore, if present, this symptom would help a



clinician diagnose BD rather than borderline personality disorder.

**(Choice B)** Impulsive or reckless behavior is characteristic of manic episodes in BD and borderline personality disorder; therefore, if present, this symptom would *not* help a clinician diagnose BD rather than borderline personality disorder.

**(Choice C)** Efforts to avoid being abandoned are characteristic of borderline personality disorder but not BD.

**(Choice D)** Suicidal ideation (thoughts about suicide) is characteristic of BD and borderline personality disorder; therefore, if present, this symptom would *not* help a clinician diagnose BD rather than borderline personality disorder.

**Educational objective:**

Bipolar disorder is characterized by mania: An elevated or irritable mood, feelings of grandiosity, reduced need for sleep, flight of ideas (rapid thoughts), and risky behaviors. Most people with bipolar disorder also experience depressive episodes: Feelings of sadness/hopelessness, lack of interest in activities, sleep disturbances, and thoughts of death or suicide.

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Behavioral Sciences

**QID:**400607

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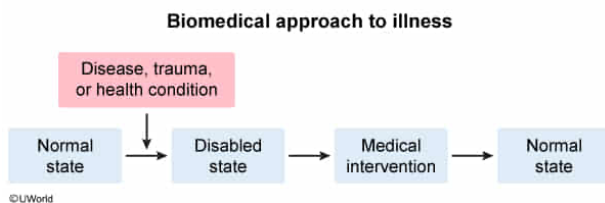
The biomedical approach to mental illness is best demonstrated by:

- ☐ A. the systematic underdiagnosis of BD by the medical community. [16%]
- ✓ ☒ B. pharmaceutical companies attempting to raise awareness about BD. [65%]
- ☐ C. BD patients' inability to recognize symptoms of mania as problematic. [5%]
- ☐ D. proactive strategies encouraging self-identification of manic symptoms. [13%]

Correct

65% answered correctly

### Explanation:



The **biomedical approach** to mental illness suggests that **physiological causes** (abnormal brain chemistry) result in psychological symptoms, and therefore **medical treatment** is advised to fix the underlying problem. This approach is best demonstrated by pharmaceutical companies raising BD symptom awareness while offering new drug therapies.

The biomedical approach (also known as the biomedical model) emphasizes **diagnosis** (ie, disease identification based on symptoms and/or diagnostic testing) and **treatment** (eg, drugs, surgery). Predominant in American medicine, this approach assumes that medical intervention can *fix* the problem and the patient will play a *passive role* in the process.

The advantages to this approach include increased life expectancy rates, demonstrated effectiveness for many illnesses, and improved quality of life for some patients, particularly those with chronic conditions who greatly benefit from drug therapy. However, this approach is not effective for many individuals with psychological disorders. Disadvantages of this approach include its narrow focus, which ignores other (eg, social) factors, and its reliance on drugs, many of which can produce harmful side effects.

**(Choice A)** The biomedical model has been correlated with *overdiagnosis* of disease, partially as the result of drug companies developing and promoting the use of new therapies among the medical community and consumers.

**(Choices C and D)** The biomedical model emphasizes the role of the physician and medical system in diagnosing and treating disease, and assumes that the patient will play a passive role. Therefore, neither the failure of patients to recognize their symptoms nor proactive strategies encouraging symptom recognition align with this model.

**Educational objective:**

The biomedical approach to mental illness emphasizes the diagnosis of physiological causes (abnormal brain chemistry) by physicians and the treatment of symptoms using drugs. This approach has helped many, but it has not been effective for everyone: Its narrow focus ignores other factors related to illness, and drug treatment can produce harmful side effects.

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**Subject:**  
Behavioral Sciences

**QID:**400608  
**System:**  
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What does the physician's quote in the passage best exemplify?

✔ ☒ A. Availability heuristic [60%]

☐ B. Belief perseverance [15%]

- ☐ C. Overconfidence bias [3%]
- ☐ D. Representativeness heuristic [20%]

Correct

60% answered correctly

### Explanation:

| Availability heuristic                                                                                             | Representativeness heuristic                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| How easily something comes to memory (eg, assuming shark attacks are common after seeing one reported on the news) | How well something matches a mental prototype (eg, assuming a woman dressed in scrubs is a nurse rather than a surgeon) |

In psychology, **heuristics** are defined as **mental shortcuts** that allow for more rapid problem solving and faster decision making than algorithms (ie, step-by-step processes that guarantee a correct solution but can be time intensive). Although faster, heuristics are often less accurate. The two major types are the availability heuristic and the representativeness heuristic.

The **availability heuristic** is the tendency to make decisions or base judgments on how easily something is recalled from memory. In other words, things that are **readily available in memory** are thought to be more common. The physician's quote describing heightened exposure to the symptoms of BD leading to a propensity to overdiagnose is an example of the availability heuristic influencing a decision-making process.

The **representativeness heuristic** is the tendency to compare things (eg, people, events) to existing **mental prototypes** when making judgments. Mental representations (eg, nurses tend to be women) may cause one to draw a conclusion that is inaccurate, such as assuming that a woman in scrubs is a nurse instead of a doctor (**Choice D**).

(**Choice B**) Belief perseverance occurs when one refuses to be influenced in the face of convincing evidence. In other words, the original belief is maintained despite new information to the contrary. There is no evidence that the physician is refusing to be persuaded.

(**Choice C**) The overconfidence bias occurs when one's confidence in knowledge or abilities exceeds accuracy (eg, an individual who is sure of acing a test but actually receives an average grade). The physician does not indicate overconfidence.

### Educational objective:

Heuristics are mental shortcuts that save time but are often less accurate. The availability heuristic is the tendency to believe that if something is easily recalled from memory, it must be common. The representativeness heuristic is the tendency to compare things (eg, people, events) to our mental prototypes when coming to conclusions.

Time spent:0 sec

Subject:

Behavioral Sciences

QID:400609

System:

Demographics and Social Structure

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Does the quote from Patient 3 reflect the sociological concept of the illness experience?

- ☐ A. Yes, the quote suggests an unconscious desire to remain ill. [1%]
- ☐ B. No, the quote better reflects a stigmatized approach to mental illness. [2%]
- ☒ C. Yes, the quote reflects meaning-making about and management of the illness. [76%]

- ☐ D. No, the quote suggests that the patient's self-identity is changed by the illness.  
[19%]

Correct

76% answered correctly

### Explanation:

The **illness experience** is a symbolic interactionist perspective that examines how individuals **understand** and **cope** with serious or chronic **illnesses** that **impact daily life** and **self-identity**. The illness experience includes strategies employed by individuals who are chronically ill:

- **Illness work** involves gathering information about one's illness, seeking treatment, taking medications, and other illness-related activities.
- **Everyday work** involves other daily activities that do not directly involve managing one's illness but are nevertheless impacted by one's illness, such as maintaining a household, working, and caring for loved ones.
- **Biographical work** involves making sense of the illness for oneself and for others, such as explaining the illness to coworkers, friends, and family.

Patient 3's quote discusses the emotional and practical impact of BD in terms of acknowledging one's illness and managing it through medication as well as the effect this acknowledgment has on the patient's sense of identity, all of which reflect the illness experience.

**(Choice A)** The illness experience does not address unconscious desires relating to illness, and the quote does not appear to suggest this either.

**(Choice B)** Stigmatization refers to the process of society labeling traits or qualities as undesirable. Mental illness is often stigmatized, but the quote does not address the way others perceive or interact with the patient.

**(Choice D)** The quote suggests that the patient's self-identity adapts to incorporate BD; however, changes to self-identity related to illness *are* included as part of the illness experience approach.

### Educational objective:

The illness experience discusses how chronically ill individuals make sense of and manage their illness in daily life and what effect illness has on their sense of self-identity. Chronically ill individuals employ strategies that involve illness work (eg, taking medications), everyday work (eg, maintaining a household), and biographical work (eg, explaining the illness to others) to cope with and make sense of their illness.

Time spent: 0 sec

Subject:

Behavioral Sciences

QID: 400610

System:

Demographics and Social Structure